

Portfolio Website — Project Handoff v8

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Session focus: About page completion, Photography page, sitewide link treatment, design system decisions.

Active branch: design-v2

Dev server: `cd ~/Desktop/Claude/portfolio/claude-written/danny-portfolio && npm run dev`

01. Current Build State

Item	Status	Notes
Homepage /	DONE	Nav, hero, stats, case study cards, origin, philosophy, footer. All complete.
Work /work	DONE	Dark mode fix applied. Text colors use CSS variables.
About /about	DONE	Bio, stats, skill cards, things you didn't ask about, videos, photography teaser. Eyebrow labels changed to secondary gray. Links have three-signal treatment.
Photography /photography	DONE	Empathique, Carl photo, photo grid, Papa Carl quote. Light/dark mode confirmed working.
Contact /contact	TODO	Not yet built. No spec defined yet.
Case study: Self-Service Portal	PARTIAL	Hero updated. Body sections present. Full page not built.
Case study: Fraud Prevention	PARTIAL	Hero at 0% 60%. Body sections present.
Case study: Messaging API	PARTIAL	All image paths fixed.
Case study: Universal College App	PARTIAL	All paths confirmed.
Netlify deployment	TODO	netlify.toml and @netlify/plugin-nextjs in place. Repo not yet connected.

02. What Happened This Session

About Page — Completed

- Removed duplicate `@theme` block from `globals.css` (was conflicting with authoritative `@theme` inline at line 82)

- Halved all five border radius tokens in @theme inline
- Added light mode base CSS rules for all about-* classes
- Fixed dark mode about-card to match philosophy-card glassmorphism exactly
- Removed opacity-0 from all three FloatingRings JSX instances
- Added .beyond-rings { opacity: 0.06 } light mode, 0.18 dark mode
- Restored Unicode arrow U+2192 confirmed correct in stats row
- Rebuilt Beyond the Work section: six skill-transfer cards with blue badges and skill dividers
- Built Things You Didn't Ask About section: six personality cards in approved order
- Embedded two YouTube videos: live guitar performance and Fortnite commercial

Photography Page — New Page Built

- Created app/photography/page.tsx with full content from About page
- Added Photography to NAV_LINKS in components/layout/Nav.tsx
- Added Photography to NAV_LINKS in components/layout/Footer.tsx
- Replaced full photography section on About with Empathique teaser + View photography link
- Light and dark mode both confirmed working

Sitewide Design System Changes

- Link treatment: all links now use three signals — color #3B5CE8 + underline (offset 3px, thickness 1px) + chevron SVG arrow
- Applied to: About page (LinkedIn, email, View photography), Footer (email, LinkedIn), CaseStudyTemplate (prev/next titles)
- Eyebrow labels changed from #3B5CE8 to var(--color-text-secondary) on About page — WCAG AA compliance
- Stat numbers remain blue — approved use of #3B5CE8
- MCP config synced: Claude Desktop now has filesystem, 21st-magic (with API key), playwright, context-mode

Documents Created

- DisplayedUX-Design-Guide-v2.docx + PDF — full design system reference with 10 sections

03. Design System Decisions — Now Locked

Link treatment	Three signals required on every link: (1) color #3B5CE8, (2) underline text-decoration: 3px text-decoration-thickness: 1px, (3) chevron SVG arrow. Never color alone.
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Rule of Three	Danny's core principle: every differentiated or interactive element must have three visual signals. Color, size, weight, shape, or character. Never one signal only.
Eyebrow labels	All small uppercase tracking text uses <code>var(--color-text-secondary)</code> . Never <code>#3B5CE8</code> . Blue fails WCAG AA at small sizes in dark mode (~3.8:1 contrast).
Blue reserved for	Stat numbers, interactive links, skill badge pills, active nav underline indicator.
Nav links exempt	Navigation links have their own active/hover treatment and are exempt from the underline+chevron rule.
Button CTAs exempt	Button-style CTAs with full borders (hero CTAs, Resume button) are exempt — the border serves as the third signal.

04. Critical File Locations

Nav component	<code>components/layout/Nav.tsx</code> (NOT <code>app/components/</code>)
Footer component	<code>components/layout/Footer.tsx</code> (NOT <code>app/components/</code>)
About page	<code>app/about/page.tsx</code>
Photography page	<code>app/photography/page.tsx</code>
Global CSS	<code>app/globals.css</code> — single source of truth for all theme tokens
@theme inline block	Line 82 of <code>globals.css</code> — authoritative Tailwind v4 token block
About dark mode CSS	Lines 515-600 of <code>globals.css</code> — Block 9, all <code>about-*</code> selectors

05. Next Steps — Ordered Priority

Priority 1: Contact Page

No spec defined yet. Confirm with Danny at session start:

- Email link only, or form with fields?
- Any specific copy or CTA?
- Build `app/contact/page.tsx` following same dark mode patterns as corrected pages
- Apply three-signal link treatment to any links on the page
- Eyebrow label must use `var(--color-text-secondary)`

Priority 2: Four Case Study Pages

Route structure: `app/work/[slug]/page.tsx`. Build Self-Service Portal first — richest asset library.

- self-service-portal, fraud-prevention, messaging-api, universal-college-app
- Each needs: full-width hero, bento stats grid, narrative sections with process images, reflection, next case study nav
- Hero images in `public/images/1-4` numbered folders under `/hero/`
- All "View case study" links currently go nowhere
- Apply three-signal link treatment to all in-page links

Priority 3: Remaining Sitewide Cleanup

- Apply eyebrow label fix (blue → secondary gray) to homepage and work page — verify these haven't been missed
- Verify work page text colors fully use CSS variables (`text-brand-charcoal` may still be hardcoded)
- Convert `.mov` performance video to MP4 for web

Priority 4: Netlify Deployment

- Push `design-v2` branch to GitHub repository
- Log into Netlify, connect repository, select `design-v2` as production branch
- Build command: `npm run build`. Publish directory: `.next`
- Confirm `@netlify/plugin-nextjs` in `package.json` `devDependencies` (already done)
- Confirm `netlify.toml` exists at project root (already done)
- Add custom domain in Netlify dashboard once DNS is ready
- Test all four case study routes on live URL before sharing

06. Critical Project Rules — Never Violate These

Tailwind v4

Config file ignored	<code>tailwind.config.ts</code> is completely ignored. Never create or edit it.
Single <code>@theme</code> block	Only one <code>@theme</code> inline block at line 82 of <code>globals.css</code> . Never add a second one.
Dark mode system	<code>[data-theme="dark"]</code> attribute selectors only. Never use Tailwind dark: utilities.
Dark mode location	All dark mode styles go in <code>globals.css</code> as <code>[data-theme="dark"] .classname</code> selectors.

File Edit Rules

Never use sed	sed silently corrupts TSX/JSX. Use Python string replacement only.
Cat before writing	Always cat the file immediately before writing replacement strings. Never reuse strings from earlier in conversation.
Template literals	Backticks in Python heredocs must be actual characters, never escaped. Grep-verify after any JSX file write.
Verify after write	Always run <code>wc -l</code> and <code>head -5</code> after writing. Then screenshot before reporting.
MISS branch	Every Python replacement must include a MISS branch that prints the unmatched string.

Dev Server Rules

Danny runs server	Claude never starts or stops the dev server unless explicitly asked.
Check server first	Before any browser action, confirm server is running at localhost:3000. If screenshot fails, ask Danny to run <code>npm run dev</code> immediately.
After branch switch	<code>rm -rf .next</code> before restarting after branch switches or Turbopack panic.
Restart command	<code>kill -f "next dev"</code> then <code>cd</code> to project and <code>npm run dev</code> .

Command Labeling

Label placement	CLAUDE CODE or TERMINAL goes as plain text on the line directly above the code block, never inside it.
TERMINAL	Danny's Mac Terminal app. Use only for pasting output back.
CLAUDE CODE	Claude Code CLI. All development work happens here.

Document Output Rule

Every document	Must be presented as BOTH .docx AND .pdf every single time, no exceptions.
Validation	Always validate .docx files after creation using the <code>validate.py</code> script from the docx skill.